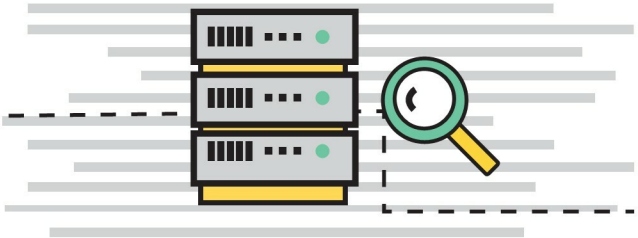


DevOps Series

Ansible Deployment of Nginx to Serve Static Files *and to Use Goaccess for Log Analysis*



This is the 15th article in the DevOps series, in which the author demonstrates how an Nginx server can be set up to serve static file content (HTML, CSS, JavaScript), and to use Goaccess for log analysis.

Nginx is a free and open source Web server written in C by Igor Sysoev. It is designed to handle thousands of client connections. It is also popularly used as a load balancer. It does not require much memory and can also be used as an HTTP cache server or a mail proxy server. It was released in 2004 and uses a BSD-like licence.

Goaccess is also free and open source software. It is a real-time Web log analyser written in C by Gerardo Orellana. You can run it remotely on a *nix terminal or access it through a browser. It requires only *ncurses* as a dependency when used from a terminal. It supports a number of Web log formats such as Apache, Nginx, Elastic load balancing, etc. You can also use a terminal dashboard with it and export reports to HTML. It was first released in 2010 and uses the MIT licence.

GNU/Linux

A Debian 9 (x86_64) guest virtual machine (VM) instance using KVM/QEMU is chosen to install Nginx.

The host system is a Parabola GNU/ Linux-libre x86_64 system and Ansible is installed on it using the distribution

package manager. The version of Ansible used is 2.5.0 as indicated below:

```
$ ansible --version
ansible 2.5.0
  config file = /etc/ansible/ansible.cfg
  configured module search path = [u'/home/guest/.ansible/
plugins/modules', u'/usr/share/ansible/plugins/modules']
  ansible python module location = /usr/lib/python2.7/site-
packages/ansible
  executable location = /usr/bin/ansible
  python version = 2.7.14 (default, Jan 5 2018, 10:41:29)
[GCC 7.2.1 20171224]
```

You should add an entry to the */etc/hosts* file for the guest 'debian' VM as follows:

```
192.168.122.140 debian
```

On the host system, we will create a project directory structure to store the Ansible playbooks, the inventory and static Web files: